



Belize



Costa Rica



Cuba



Dominica

Dominican
Republic

El Salvador



Grenada



Guatemala



City of chocolate

The densely populated Mexico City is built on a lake called Texcoco. Its indigenous tribes were some of the first in the world to turn cacao beans into tasty chocolate almost 4,000 years ago!

The Day of the Dead

Every year in Mexico, a festival is held to remember people who have died. It is called the Day of the Dead and takes place at the end of October. Families have picnics by the graves of their relatives. When night falls, they keep watch over the graveyard by candlelight.

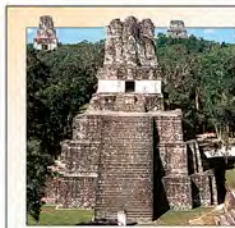


A sugary souvenir of the festival.



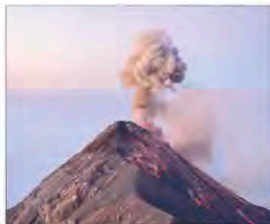
A modern mix

Many Caribbean people are descendants of African slaves who were forced to work on sugar plantations. Slavery was stopped in the 19th century, and many Asians then came to work in the Caribbean. Their descendants still live there today.



Terrific temples

More than 1,000 years ago, the ancient Mayans built impressive temples, especially in Mexico. Mayan society was very sophisticated long before the Spaniards invaded in the 16th century.



Natural disasters

Central America has many natural hazards, such as volcanoes, earthquakes, and hurricanes. Volcanoes have become popular with tourists, and some now have trails and cable cars up them.



Haiti



Honduras



Jamaica



Mexico



Nicaragua



Panama



St. Kitts-Nevis



St. Lucia

St. Vincent and
the GrenadinesTrinidad
and Tobago

Caribbean people

More than fifty different ethnic groups live on the islands of the Caribbean. Here are just a few.



Asian



Arawak



Afro-Caribbean



European

